

PROJECT: IN THE NAME OF LOVE

CHAPTER 1 - SIDE B: NARRATIVE STEP OUTLINE

PREVIOUSLY: Tamami Hanami has been healed by Mori Midori, but at great cost. Midori is drained of "Primater." The threat is not over.

SCENE 7: THE OATH & THE FIRST TRANSFORMATION

Location: Alleyway **Characters:** Tamami Hanami, Torey, Love, Mori Midori

- **THE REALITY CHECK:** Love explains that because Midori saved Hanami, Midori cannot fight. Hanami *must* fight in her place.
 - *Hanami:* Protests immediately. "I can't fight!"
 - *Love:* He is brutally honest. She isn't special or a "chosen one." It would be easier to connect with Torey instead of a "hag" (Hanami mutters: "I'm barely 30"), but since Hanami has Midori's "Primater" mixed in her blood, she is the only compatible option.
- **THE MOTIVATION:** Torey hypes her up, reminding Hanami this was her childhood dream. Midori whispers that she believes in her.
- **THE RITUAL:** Hanami swallows her fear. She places her hand over Midori's hand. Love places his paw on top.
 - *The Oath:* Love guides her to recite the pledge. She exclaims: "I will fight in the name of Love!" (referring to the cat).
- **THE TRANSFORMATION:**
 - *The Sensation:* Hanami's eyes go purple. Her body rises as if possessed. She briefly sees a cloudy purple void where two massive feline eyes gaze at her.
 - *The Naked Truth:* In reality, her clothes are magically torn to pieces. For a fraction of a second, she is naked.
 - *The Gag:* Torey takes this extremely slim opportunity to snap a selfie.
 - *The Costume:* Her teacher suit transforms into a light blue, stereotypical magical girl dress with music note details. Her briefcase becomes a Cymbal-shaped shield. Her microphone becomes a Mic-shaped sword.
- **THE LANDING:** She lands on one knee heroically. A moment later, she flushes with shame about the short length of the skirt.
 - *Torey:* "It suits you."
 - *Midori's Note:* The "Prime Dress" is the crystallization of the user's self-perception. Hanami sees herself as a cliché, failed idol, so her armor is a cliché, flimsy costume.

SCENE 8: THE BEHEMOTH OF SCRAP

Location: Alleyway / Street **Characters:** Hanami, Behemoth, Nyall R. Thotep (The Hat Man)

- **THE INTRUSION:** The surroundings rumble. Buildings crumble; car alarms trigger before being crushed. A brutish laughter is heard.

- **THE MONSTER: A Behemoth** appears at the top of a building.
 - *Visuals:* Short, stubby legs. A massive upper body made of automobile parts (windshields, mirrors, pipes, tires). He wears a completely destroyed shirt and tie.
- **THE MASTERMIND:** Nyall R. Thotep sits on the Behemoth's shoulder.
 - *Hat Man:* "Would you look at that? Seems our friend got himself a new playdoll."
 - *Behemoth:* "Doll... break. Break!"
 - *Hat Man:* Taps his shoulder. "That's the spirit." He vanishes, reappearing on a rooftop to watch as the Behemoth jumps into the "arena."

SCENE 9: THE FAILED HEROINE (THE CRASH COURSE)

Location: Street "Arena" **Characters:** Hanami, Behemoth, Love, Midori, Torey

- **THE HESITATION:** Hanami confronts him, sword and shield ready, but she is visibly shaking.
- **THE CATCHPHRASE:** Love demands she say a line.
 - *Hanami:* "I-I can't say that. It's too shameful!"
 - *Love:* "Say it!"
 - *Hanami (Meekly):* "Uhm... Evil of this pure world, I shall strike you down in the name of Love!"
- **THE REALITY:** The Behemoth remains weirdly quiet. Then, with a mighty swing of his steel pipe, he sends Hanami flying against a wall.
 - *Torey:* "Oof."
 - *Love:* Grabs his head with one paw (Facepalm).
- **THE BEATDOWN:** Hanami crawls out of the wall crater, barely covering herself with her dented shield. Her dress is ripped, her sword broken in two.
 - *Behemoth:* "Bah. Break doll easy." He turns his back on her to face Midori and Torey.
 - *The Sneak Attack:* Hanami stabs his leg with her broken sword. "Pay... attention... to your teacher."
 - *The Counter:* Annoyed, the Behemoth kicks back, sending her flying again. She manages to block but hangs from the floor.
- **THE DESPERATION:**
 - *Midori:* "Love. She won't be able to do this alone."
 - *Love:* Points to Torey. "Maybe, we will try with the other one then."
 - *Midori:* "Love..." (Disapproving). Love scuffs and jumps to help Hanami.
 - *Midori's Request:* She turns to Torey. "Excuse me, I know it's I who is supposed to help you, but may I ask you for some help?" Torey is surprised.
- **THE CRASH COURSE:**
 - *Love:* "On your feet! There's a battle to have! Hit it, and don't get hit. Then hit it harder."
 - *Hanami:* "It's not... that easy."
 - *Love:* "It is all in your head."
 - *Hanami:* "What? No! I'm pretty sure it's all around my body!"

- *The Lesson:* Love explains her body is a manifestation of her self-perception. "Focus on what you want to be! Focus on your deepest desires, and ACT!"
- **THE TURNING POINT:**
 - Love pounces around her, guiding her steps. They dodge two attacks.
 - *Love:* "This won't go anywhere if you simply defend yourself! Your tools are merely transmitters of your emotions... YOU are the weapon!"
 - *The Action:* The Behemoth strikes. Hanami drops her sword and **punches** the exhaust pipe weapon. It snaps in half.
 - *Hanami:* "Dang it, that hurt!"
 - *Love:* "You shall get used to it."
 - *Hat Man (Rooftop):* "Oh, he's not going to like that."
- **THE TANTRUM:** The Behemoth looks at his broken weapon confused, then throws it down. "No! You no break toy! Toy break you!"
 - He unleashes a barrage of hammer fists. Hanami retreats, blocking with her dented shield, losing breathing room.
- **THE GAG:** Love lunges at the Behemoth's face. The monster snatches the cat and throws him onto Hanami.
 - *Love:* Hangs from Hanami for a second. "Thanks for the catch."
 - *Hanami:* "Claws! Claws!"

SCENE 10: THE BROADCAST (MIDORI'S LAST STAND)

Location: Street / News Helicopters / Citywide **Characters:** Midori, Torey, Reporters (Cassidy Sr. & Jr.), The Citizens

- **THE INTERVENTION:** The Behemoth prepares to crush Hanami.
 - *Midori:* "Friends! Please excuse me to bother you so late at night! I humbly ask for your help!"
 - She stands with a **Magical Megaphone**, holding Torey's hand. Magic flows from Torey to the Megaphone.
- **THE MEDIA COVERAGE:**
 - *Cassidy Sr. (Studio):* "We have news once more from Cassidy Lane Jr... We are with you Cassidy."
 - *Cassidy Jr. (Helicopter):* "Thanks Cassidy." (It is obvious they are mother and daughter). "Midori is on the ground... A very rude looking young girl seems to be helping her up."
 - *Torey (On Mic):* "Hey!"
 - *Cassidy Sr.:* "...what?"
- **THE SPEECH:** Midori smiles at the helicopter. The Behemoth walks slowly toward them.
 - *Midori:* "Hello to the young hearts... and to those who keep our streets alive... I am deeply ashamed to bother you, but I really-really need everyone to do me a HUGE favour."
 - *The Living Room:* A child watches. "Mommy, it's Midori." The parents feign interest until the child says, "...I don't know [if she's winning]." They stop working to watch.

- *Midori*: "I love the hard working people... I love every bird, and every rat on this land... I will fight for you to my last breath."
- **THE REQUEST:** The Behemoth raises his fists.
 - *Midori*: "If you love me back, even slightly... Focus deeply on that love... And give it to her!" She points at Hanami.
- **THE GRAPPLE:** A VERY battered Hanami lunges onto the Behemoth's arm, biting him and stabbing her nails in to hold a judo lock.
 - *Cassidy Jr.*: "The stranger... she's biting him."
 - *Love*: "Parry that!" (As the Behemoth bashes Hanami against the ground).
- **THE CONFESSION & THE TRANSFER:**
 - *Midori*: "The world is scary... It's going to beat you down, again and again." (Synchronized with the Behemoth smashing Hanami).
 - Midori releases Torey. A light green, pulsing ethereal orb sprouts from her chest.
 - *Midori*: "I know I am in no place to ask you anything, but please care for this one wish of mine... Believe in her, because she NEEDS you."
 - *The Name Drop*: "Lincourt City! If life is a nightmare, believe IN YOUR DREAMS! Believe in **Yumeno Lyrica!**"
- **THE REACTION:**
 - *The Public*: "Yumeno Lyrica?"
 - *Club Guy*: "More like Suckmeno kicked ass... I tried, ok?"
- **THE SACRIFICE:** Hanami loses consciousness. The Behemoth dangles her by two fingers.
 - *Midori*: "Be brave... be bold... And most importantly... be kind."
 - *The Stare*: The orb shines brightest. Midori locks eyes with the Hat Man. Her smile fades into a stern look of defiance. The Hat Man looks confused.
 - *The Farewell*: "Oh, and of course! Don't forget to eat your veggies!" She flashes a peace sign. The megaphone melts into the orb. Midori collapses.
 - *Love*: "Midori!? Wait! No!"
- **THE THROW:** Torey flings the orb. It hits Hanami, sinking into her body. It turns **Deep Purple**. A cocoon of bandages wraps Hanami like a mummy. The Behemoth breaks his teeth trying to bite it.

SCENE 11: THE VOID (INTERNAL STRUGGLE)

Location: Mental Void **Characters:** Hanami, The Entity (Cat Eyes)

- **THE AWAKENING:** Hanami wakes in a void. She realizes she is flying and naked (no skin shown).
 - *Hanami*: "Where... where am I? Am I dead?"
 - *Entity*: Two MASSIVE feline eyes appear. "No, not yet. Does thou wish to?"
 - *Hanami*: "Uhm... Do I get to choose?"
 - *Entity*: "It is often such case." (Blinks, shaking the void).
 - *Hanami*: "Uhm, well... then. I guess I would like to not die, please."

- **THE TEST:** Purple bandages chain her arms and legs, pulling her down.
 - *Entity:* "Thou does not sound too sure about thy decision."
 - *Hanami:* "I am very sure! I do not want to die!"
 - *Entity:* "But does thou wish to LIVE?"
- **THE MISERY:** The void fills with images of her life: students disrespecting her, Torey laughing, customers taking upskirt photos, rejection at clubs, looking in the mirror feeling fat.
 - *Entity:* "Thy life appears to be one of misery and defeat. Are thou certain thou wish to return to such life? Thou can remain here, with me. It is peaceful."
- **THE TURNING POINT:** Hanami stops struggling, sinking into nothingness.
 - *Torey's Voice:* "Oi! Tatami-san! Get up, you hag!"
 - *The Glitch:* The images of misery glitch.
 - *Hanami:* "It's... sensei. You disrespectful... little shit."
 - *The Shift:* Hanami pushes off. The images change to moments of joy: bonding with Torey, watching Midori, working on her parents' farm.
- **THE ANSWER:**
 - *Torey (Voice):* "Get up and fight! Yumeno Lyrica! I believe in you!"
 - *Entity:* "Does one seek to live!?"
 - *Hanami:* "**YES!**"
 - *Entity:* "Why for!?"
 - *Hanami:* "**It is my life! That's enough reason to fight for!**"
 - *Entity:* "Then rise! Rise and fight on my name, my avatar!"
- **THE ASCENSION:** Hanami's eyes shine light blue through the bandages.

SCENE 12: THE TRUE AWAKENING (SHOGUN HANAMI)

Location: Street "Arena" **Characters:** Shogun Hanami, Behemoth, Torey, Love

- **THE EXPLOSION:** The cocoon explodes.
 - *The Flash:* Hanami is naked for a split second. Parents cover children's eyes; Torey snaps a picture.
- **THE ARMOR:** The bandages swirl and harden into a **Shogun Armor** with musical details, a cape, and a Demon Cat mask. Her voice is deeper.
- **THE FIGHT:**
 - *Hanami:* "Stand back." (To Love).
 - The Behemoth smashes her into the ground. She is flattened... but she isn't there.
 - She appears behind him. He smashes her into a wall. The wall is intact; she is gone.
 - She circles him. He punches again.
 - *The Illusion:* Hanami puts her sword back in the scabbard, as if she barely took it out. The Behemoth doesn't realize his arm has been left behind (illusion/speed).
- **THE CLONES:**

- *Hanami*: "OSU!" (Hits her chest).
- Dozens of clones appear, shouting "OSU!" Ethereal drums appear.
- The Behemoth tries to hit them with his severed arms, but phases through.
- One clone begins to orchestrate the drummers.

SCENE 13: THE REQUIEM

Location: Street "Arena" **Characters:** Shogun Hanami, Behemoth

- **THE RITUAL:** Hanami speaks solemnly as the drums play.
 - "I am the spear, and the shield." (Behemoth is trapped in a sound bubble).
 - "I am the door, and the wall." (Behemoth bashes his head against the bubble).
 - "I am the key, and the lock." (Hanami nocks her glowing Katana into her Bow).
- **THE FINISHER:**
 - *Hanami*: "This is my hymn; your requiem. **Finita Stacatto!**"
 - She fires the sword. It flies at him but hits the sound bubble instead of his head.
 - *The Vibration*: It sends a vibration through the bubble. Again and again. Faster. The drummers accelerate.
 - *The Effect*: The Behemoth thrashes in a craze. His eyes and ears bleed dark purple.
- **THE END:** Hanami turns her back. She sheathes the sword (which is magically back with her).
 - *Sound*: The air vacuums into the sheath. Complete silence.
 - *Atmosphere*: It starts to rain.
 - *Behemoth*: Sits down, astonished. "Tan U... nice lady."
 - *Hanami*: "Sayonara."
 - *Result*: The Behemoth's head bursts into thousands of pieces.

SCENE 14: THE SILENCE (ENDING)

Location: Street "Arena" **Characters:** Hanami, Torey, Midori, Love, Thotep

- **THE AFTERMATH:** The clones vanish. Hanami reverts to human form and falls to her knees.
 - *Cassidy Sr. (Studio)*: "W-What happened!? Roll that back!"
 - *Hat Man (Rooftop)*: His confusion turns to a sardonic dark smile. "I guess he let it get to his head." He disappears in purple smoke.
- **THE TRAGEDY:** Hanami crawls to Midori.
 - *Hanami*: "Midori-dono, we-we... did it."
 - *Torey*: Shrugging, holding back tears. "Sensei-..."
 - *Love*: Unbothered by the rain, walks solemnly to Midori and curls on her lap.
- **THE REVEAL:** Midori is no longer a magical girl.
 - *Visual*: She is wearing a **Nun's Habit**. She is barely a teenager, maybe 20.
 - *State*: Eyes closed, head down, a wide warm smile frozen on her face. Her hand is frozen cold.

- **THE FADE:** Hanami's face shrugs, about to burst into tears, but her body gives up. She faints at the nun's feet.
 - *Torey:* "Tamami Sensei!"